AI ON THE RISE · UNITED AIRLINES

United bans AI agents from booking flights for travelers

The agent was not the problem. The missing rules were.

Victor Slompo · vssolutions.io

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WHAT HAPPENED

United is blocking outside AI agents from making reservations

United says sharing credentials with third-party AI assistants can expose sensitive information and cause unintended purchases. It is restricting access on its own platforms and through agencies and aggregators. Southwest took the opposite tack and opened its inventory to ChatGPT users.

WHAT CHANGES

What this signals about agents that buy for customers

01 The business decides whether an outside agent may act at all

02 Credentials and payments are where the risk concentrates

03 Two airlines, two opposite policies on the same technology

THE REAL PROBLEM IN COMPANIES

What I see in companies: the agent ships before the rules exist

01 Nobody defines where the agent may act and where it may not

02 Access to payments and data is granted before anyone decides who is liable

03 The company does not control the channel, so it cannot control the outcome

I'VE ALREADY SOLVED THIS

A building materials store in southern Brazil: an agent inside its own channel

01 AI sales rep on WhatsApp: one agent and three tools, 9 nodes in the whole flow

02 Rules: no made-up specs, never reveals stock, never gives discounts

03 **65 out of 65 real customer questions found the right product**

MY TAKE

Simple that works beats complex that impresses.

United is drawing a line around where an agent may act. In practice, that is the right question to start with. An agent with a defined channel, a few tools and hard rules is easier to trust and easier to measure than one with open access.

WANT TO SEE HOW I DID IT?

Comment SDR.

I'll send you the step-by-step of this case by DM. I take AI off the drawing board and put it into production, with measured results.

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